Ringan (a discussion about enlightenment)', Lakshmikant Deshmukh was to discuss progressive writing as a tool for political mobilization, Pramod Mujumdar was to discuss the religious traditions of Sufi sects and Bhakti traditions, and Dhanaji Gurav was to discuss Maharashtra's cultural traditions as a counter to Hindutva. More than seventy people, including Datta Bhagat, Kumar Ketkar and Dr Ganesh Devy attended the meeting. The session lasted about fifty minutes, and Rahul spoke for just ten. He raised some very important points, but the one that really stayed with me was this (even though it was a deviation from the subject of discussion): He said that he had interacted with close to 10,000 young Indians across five states so far, and nearly everybody wanted to pursue a career in one of these five streams—medicine (mostly as doctors), civil services, engineering, police and law. He posited that these had limited avenues, since the supply far outstripped the demand. As a result, traditional professions that could be massive employment generators were dying out. Rahul was especially interested in how we could resocialize our youth so they got productive employment, while helping the nation. But rather than just musing out loud, he solicited our help in this. He actively charged us with finding solutions to actualize this grand goal. This was a rather clever thing to do politically, since he emotionally bound us to him.

In stark contrast, the walking interaction I was privileged to witness was a very different experience. Even though Rahul was listening and responding to us, he was also waving at people outside of the Yatra. He was beckoning them inside, hugging them and letting them take pictures. But we (Vaibhav Shete, Suhas Phadtare, Nitin Sawant, Ganesh Pawar and I) had a long interaction with him starting from 7 a.m. After presenting him with a Lord Vitthal idol and a book on Wari, we began by reciting Saint Tukaram's abhang (sonnet), '*Je ka ranjale ganjale* (Those who are oppressed and suffering, the one who associates with them with empathy is the true saint and true God).' We went on to explain that as per Tukaram (and other saints from the common masses), ritualistic ablutions in holy rivers don't wash away sins. Instead, it is necessary to perform good deeds. This tradition was a clear rejection of superstitions and ritualistic religion, which can be